a book. When the weather was right, we'd go swimming; during the summer, we often ate our meals on the patio. There were always a dozen or so members of the White House staff with us, and on Friday and Saturday nights we usually all got together to watch a movie with big baskets of popcorn in front of us.

In a way, it was like a big family that included the camp commander, the Secret Service supervisor, our lead helicopter pilot and my military and communications aides; Mark Weinberg of the press office; Eddie Serrano, our chief steward; Dr. John Hutton and his wife, Barbara; and Jim Kuhn, my personal assistant, and his wife, Carole, who usually brought their two children with them. At first, the movies we watched were new or recent releases from Hollywood. Then I began trying to sandwich in a few older movies from my generation. Before long, the staff, most of whom were relative youngsters, only wanted to see golden oldies; so each Saturday night we'd bring out an old movie featuring stars such as Clark Gable and Barbara Stanwyck, Humphrey Bogart and Jimmy Cagney, and occasionally a couple of actors named Reagan and Davis.

Every month the White House received thousands of letters addressed to the president. A staff of volunteers went through them, and each week chose thirty or so for me to look over. I tried to answer as many as I could during the weekends at Camp David.

The letters covered every topic under the sun, a few less serious than others, as my reply to one from a young man in South Carolina indicates:

> Dear Andy:
>
> I'm sorry to be so late in answering your letter, but as you know, I've been in China and found your letter here upon my return.
>
> Your application for disaster relief has been duly noted but I must point out one technical problem; the